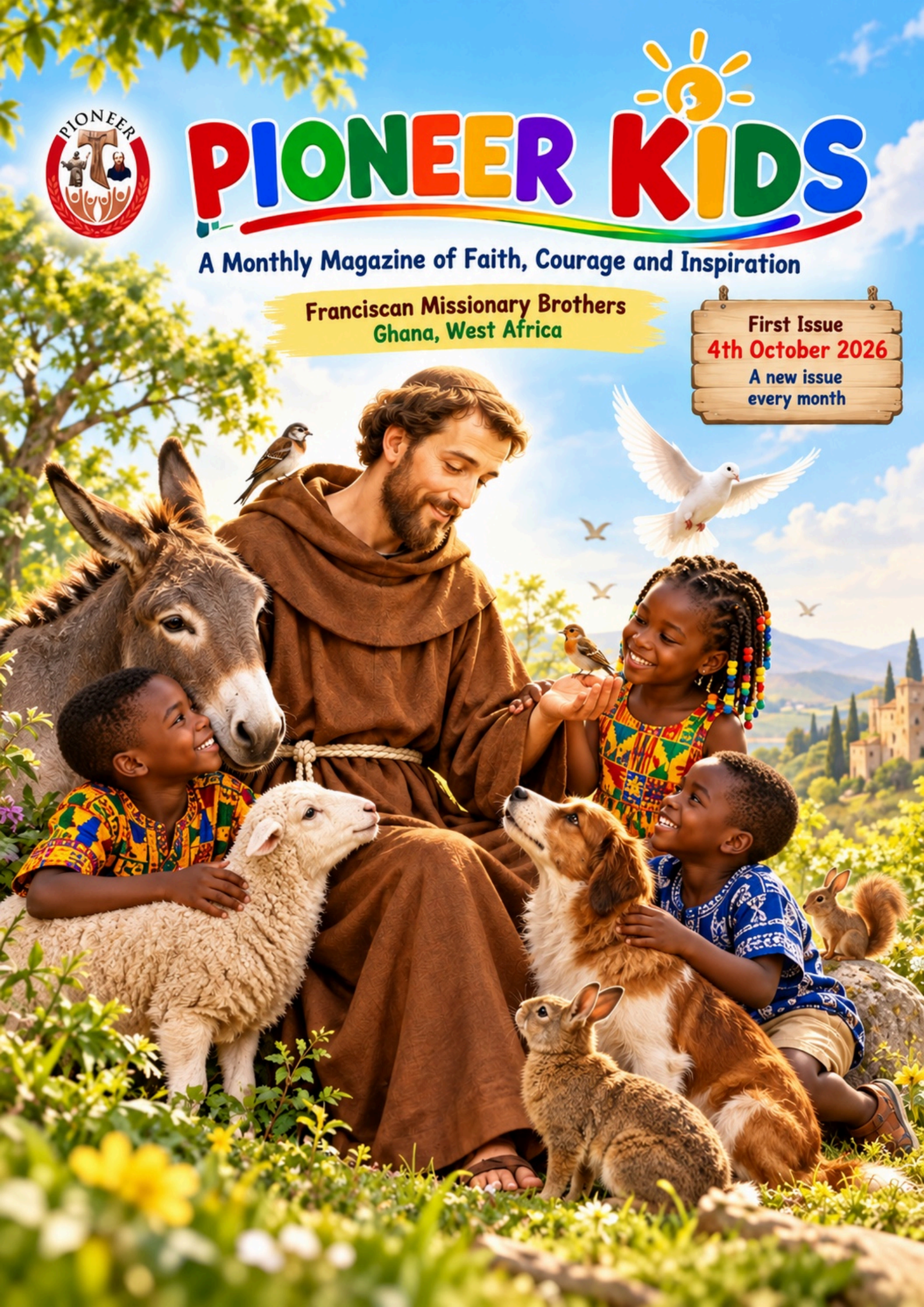

PIONEER KIDS
A Monthly Magazine of Faith, Courage and Inspiration
Franciscan Missionary Brothers
Ghana, West Africa
First Issue
4th October 2026
A new issue
every month





Editorial

A Small Beginning, a Bright Journey

Dear readers,

What would you do if a wild wolf appeared at your town gate? Would you run, hide, or try to make peace? What if you noticed a lonely classmate, a thirsty plant, or a stream filled with rubbish? Sometimes the biggest adventures begin with one small choice: to be brave, kind, and ready to help.

Welcome to the first issue of Pioneer Kids! Inside these pages, you will discover exciting stories, inspiring people, and simple ways to make a difference at home, at school, and in your community. A good story can stay with us long after we close the page. It can give us courage to tell the truth, help us notice someone who needs a friend, or remind us to care for the world we share.

That is the hope behind this magazine. Each month, Pioneer Kids will bring you stories from the Bible and the lives of saints, missionaries, and other inspiring people. We will also meet children who make thoughtful choices in ordinary places. These pages are for children, young people, and adults who want to grow together in truthfulness, kindness, gentleness, and care for others.

In this issue, St. Francis seeks peace with the wolf of Gubbio. A Samaritan stops to help a stranger. Bro. Paulus Moritz opens paths to learning. Ama and Kojo care for a stream and a little tree. Mother Teresa shows how much it matters to notice one person in need. Their stories invite us to ask: **What good can I do where I am today?**

We also hope this magazine will help you listen for your vocation. God calls people to serve in different ways. Some may become priests, religious Brothers, or religious Sisters. Others will serve through family life and the work they do each day. You need not have every answer now. Begin by learning, praying, asking questions, and sharing your gifts.

As our first issue begins on the feast of St. Francis of Assisi, let us take a small step in his spirit: speak truthfully, act kindly, and care for every person and creature we meet.

May each new issue give you a story to enjoy and a little more courage to do good.

Welcome to Pioneer Kids.

Bro. Joby P. Baby CMSF

If you have a short inspiring story, kindly email:
jobyb83@gmail.com



St. Francis and the Wolf of Gubbio

A story retold from Franciscan tradition

Many years ago, beside the little Italian town of Gubbio, a wolf lived in the hills. When night fell, he came down from the forest searching for food. He frightened the shepherds, chased their animals, and made the townspeople afraid to leave their homes.

Parents called their children indoors before sunset. Farmers hurried back from the fields. Even in daylight, people looked over their shoulders as they walked.

“Something must be done about that wolf,” they said.

One day, St. Francis came to Gubbio. He listened as the people told him what had happened. He could hear the fear in their voices, and he knew they needed help.

“I will go and speak to the wolf,” Francis said.

“Please don’t!” his friends replied. “He may hurt you.”

Francis understood their worry. Still, he believed that peace was worth seeking. He walked out through the town gate and followed the path towards the hills. A few companions came with him, though they kept their distance.

A THOUGHT FOR KIDS

Bravery begins with a kind step.



Francis Meets Brother Wolf

St. Francis and the Wolf of Gubbio

Soon the wolf appeared. He sprang forward with a fierce growl. Francis stopped, made the sign of the cross, and called to him:

“Come here, Brother Wolf. I want to speak with you.”

To everyone’s surprise, the wolf slowed down. He came near Francis and grew quiet.

Francis looked at him carefully. The wolf was frightening, but he was also thin and hungry.

“Brother Wolf,” Francis said, “you have caused great harm, and the people are afraid of you. That must end. But I can see that you need food. Perhaps we can help one another.”

Francis led the wolf back towards Gubbio. The townspeople gathered at a safe distance. Some held their children close. Others could scarcely believe that the wolf was walking peacefully beside Francis.

A THOUGHT FOR KIDS

Courage and kindness can turn fear into friendship.





A Promise of Peace

St. Francis and the Wolf of Gubbio

Francis spoke to them.

“If you give Brother Wolf food each day, he will no longer need to hunt near your homes. And Brother Wolf must leave you and your animals in peace.”

The people agreed to care for the wolf. In the story, the wolf gave Francis his paw as a sign of his promise.

Day by day, the people placed food where the wolf could find it. They watched him carefully at first. As time passed, they saw that he no longer chased their animals. Children who had once run away at the sight of him began to greet him from their doorways.

The people of Gubbio remembered what Francis had taught them. He had listened to their fear and taken it seriously. He had also noticed the wolf’s hunger. By caring for both, he helped them find a way to live in peace.

FOR YOUNG READERS

Francis was brave enough to take the first step towards peace. When you see someone left out, upset, or in need, what kind first step could you take?



PIONEER KIDS | A BIBLE STORY

The Stranger Who Stopped to Help

The parable of the Good Samaritan, retold from Luke 10:25–37

One day, a man asked Jesus, “Who is my neighbour?”

Jesus answered him with a story.

A traveller was walking from Jerusalem to Jericho. The road wound through rocky hills, and there were lonely places along the way. Suddenly, robbers attacked him. They took his belongings, hurt him, and left him beside the road.

The traveller could not get up. He listened for footsteps, hoping someone would come.

After a while, a priest walked down the road. He saw the injured man, but passed by on the other side.

Later, another man who served in the temple came along. He saw the traveller too, but he also went past.

The injured man was still alone.

Then a Samaritan came down the road. Some people in those days treated Samaritans as strangers and avoided them. Yet when this Samaritan saw the injured traveller, he felt compassion.

He stopped.

A THOUGHT FOR KIDS

Who will stop to help?



The Good Samaritan

The Stranger Who Stopped to Help

“Can you hear me?” he asked gently.

The traveller opened his eyes. The Samaritan knelt beside him, cared for his wounds, and helped him onto his own animal. He took him to an inn where he could rest safely.

The next morning, the Samaritan gave the innkeeper money.

“Please take care of him,” he said. “If it costs more, I will pay you when I return.”

When Jesus finished the story, he asked, “Which of these three men was a neighbour to the traveller?”

“The one who showed him mercy,” came the answer.

“Go and do the same,” Jesus said.

The Samaritan did not know the injured man’s name. He stopped because someone needed help. That was what made him a good neighbour.

FOR YOUNG READERS

You can be a neighbour to someone at school, at home, or on the playground. If you see a person who is hurt or alone, what can you do to help them?

A THOUGHT FOR KIDS

Mercy is love put into action.

Bro. Paulus Moritz and the School for Everyone

An inspiring story based on the life and mission of the founder of the Franciscan Missionary Brothers



BRO. PAULUS MORITZ

Imagine a child in an Indian village many years ago. Each morning, the child watches other children walk towards school. She wishes she could go with them, but her family cannot afford it.

Bro. Paulus Moritz believed that children like her deserved a chance to learn.

Paulus had travelled a long way from Germany to India. He could have chosen a more comfortable life, but he wanted to follow Jesus in the spirit of St. Francis of Assisi. He chose to live as a missionary Brother among people who were poor and often overlooked.

When Bro. Paulus visited villages, he listened to families. Some needed food. Some needed someone to care for them when they were ill. Children needed a place where they could learn. He believed that education could help them build a better future, so he and the Brothers began schools in rural communities.

We can imagine how exciting that first day of school might have felt for a child who had waited a long time: a place to sit, a lesson to learn, and a Brother who believed she could succeed.



A School for Everyone

Bro. Paulus Moritz · continued

Learning to read takes time. A child might struggle over a word, try again, and then smile when the letters finally make sense. Bro. Paulus knew that such small moments mattered. With education, children could discover their gifts and find new ways to help their families and communities.

Bro. Paulus gave the Brothers a simple message: “Take care of the poor and God will take care of you.” He wanted them to live those words through their work, wherever people needed them.

Today, his mission continues through the Franciscan Missionary Brothers. The schools and other places where they serve remind us of the choice Bro. Paulus made: to be a brother to people in need.

FOR YOUNG READERS

You may not be able to open a school, but you can help someone learn. Could you share a book, explain a lesson to a friend, or encourage a classmate who finds something difficult? A small act of care can give someone courage to try again.



The Little Tree Beside the School

Every afternoon, Ama and Kojo rested beneath the big mango tree beside their school. Its branches gave them shade, and birds sang among its leaves.

One Monday, they found plastic wrappers scattered around its roots. More rubbish lay in the small stream behind the playground.

“The rain will wash it away,” Kojo said.

“But where will it go?” Ama asked.

They followed the stream until it passed a garden. A plastic bag had caught on a young plant. Nearby, a bird tugged at a piece of packaging. Kojo hurried over and picked it up.

The next day, Ama spoke to their teacher. Together, the class made a plan. They put two bins beside the school: one for food scraps that could become compost and another for rubbish that needed collecting. After lessons, the children worked with their teacher to clear the playground and the stream bank.

Some pieces were muddy and difficult to reach. Their teacher helped them do the work safely. When they finished, the stream could flow freely again.



The Little Tree

Beside the School · continued

Then they noticed something else. A small tree near the school gate had dry soil around its roots.

“Let’s give it some water,” Kojo said.

Soon the children took turns caring for it. They watered it when needed and kept the ground around it clear. They also asked their families to use the new bins when visiting the school.

Weeks passed. One morning, Kojo saw a tiny new leaf on the little tree.

“Ama, look!” he called.

Their teacher smiled. “You cared for this place, and now you can see it growing.”

The big mango tree was still Ama and Kojo’s favourite place to sit. Now, when they looked up at its branches, they remembered the little tree too. They hoped that one day another group of children would rest in its shade.

FOR YOUNG READERS

The earth is a gift we share. What is one place near your home or school that you could help care for this week?



PIONEER KIDS | AN INSPIRING LIFE

Mother Teresa and the Children Who Needed a Teacher

An inspiring story based on the life of St. Teresa of Calcutta

Before people called her Mother Teresa, she was a teacher in Calcutta, India. She loved helping children learn. She knew the joy a child could feel when a difficult word finally made sense.

Beyond her school, however, many families were struggling. Some children had no classroom to enter. Mother Teresa noticed them, and she could not forget them.

During a train journey in 1946, she felt a deep call from Jesus to serve people who were poor and often left alone. Leaving the school she loved was difficult. Still, she chose to follow that call.

Mother Teresa began working among families in Calcutta who needed help. She cared for people who were ill and made time for children who needed kindness and attention. Soon other women joined her. Together they became the Missionaries of Charity.



A Kindness That Grew

Mother Teresa · continued

Mother Teresa could not solve every problem in one day. She could, however, notice the person in front of her. A child needed someone to teach her. A sick neighbour needed care. A person who felt forgotten needed to know that someone would stay beside them.

Years later, people around the world knew Mother Teresa’s name. She received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1979. But the heart of her work was still the care she and her Sisters gave to people, one person at a time.

FOR YOUNG READERS

You do not have to travel far to show kindness. Is there someone in your class or neighbourhood who needs help learning, a friendly welcome, or a little of your time?

A THOUGHT FOR KIDS

A small act of care can help someone feel seen.

PIONEER KIDS | DISCOVER YOUR VOCATION

Could God Be Calling You?

A life of faith, friendship and service begins with listening.

A PRIEST

St. John Bosco

He guided and taught young people, helping them grow in faith and joy.

A RELIGIOUS BROTHER

Bro. Paulus Moritz

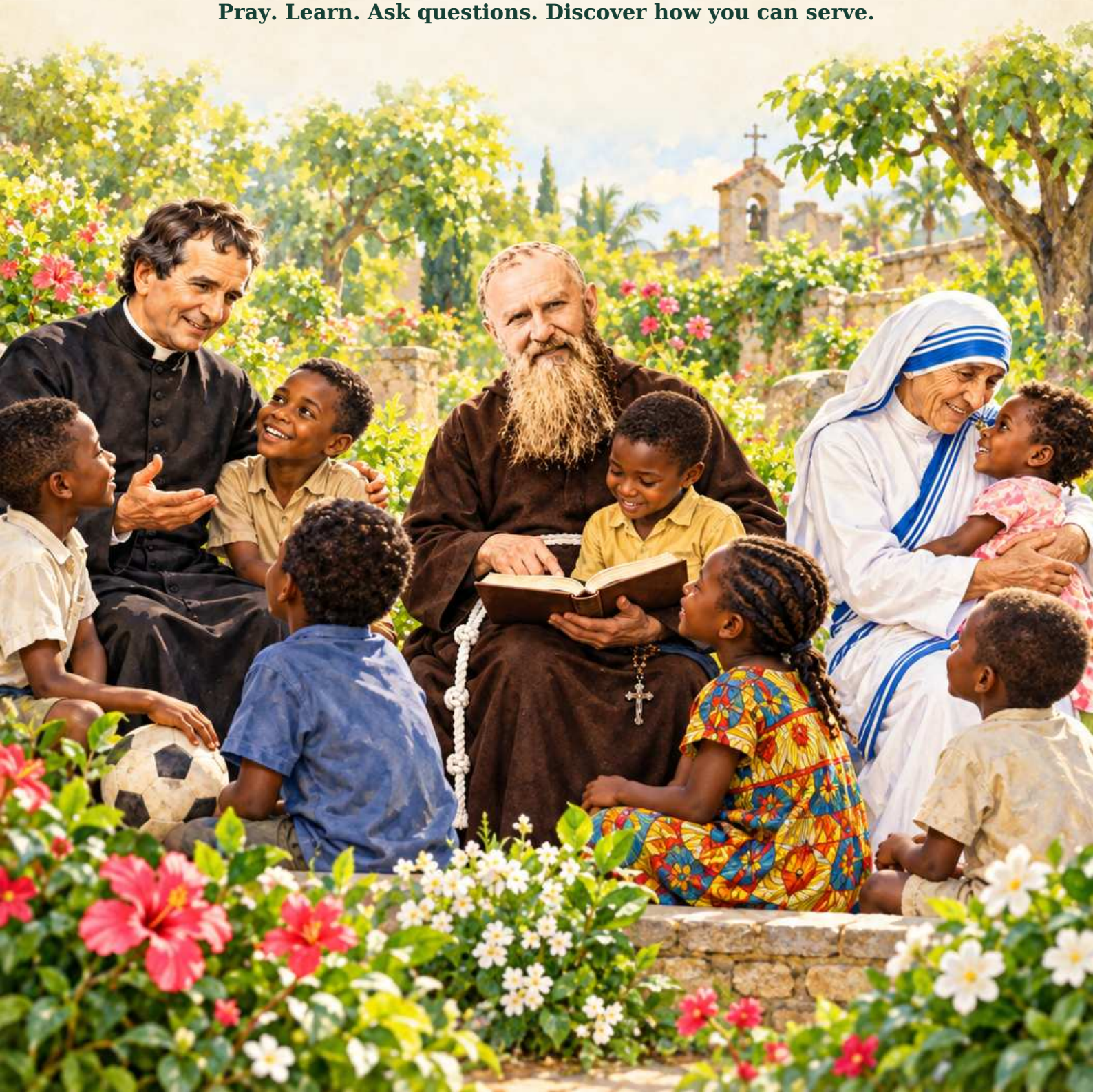
He followed Jesus as a Brother and helped children find a place to learn.

A RELIGIOUS SISTER

Mother Teresa

She served people in need with prayer, tenderness and courage.

Pray. Learn. Ask questions. Discover how you can serve.

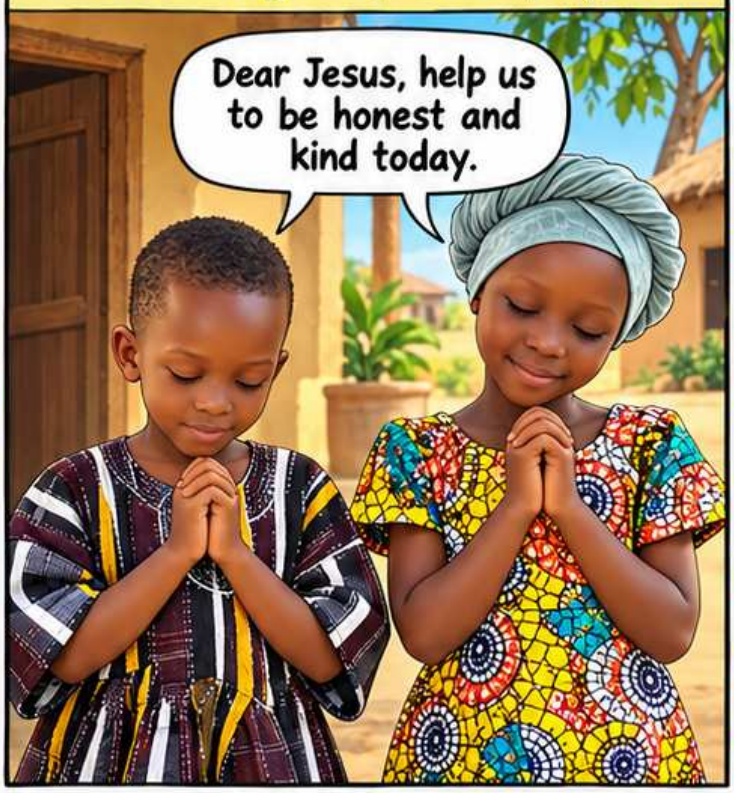


MACKAFUI AND DECO
THE WALLET AND THE PROMISE

Mother asked Mackafui and Deco to buy bread.



Before leaving, they said a prayer.



On the way, Deco found a wallet.



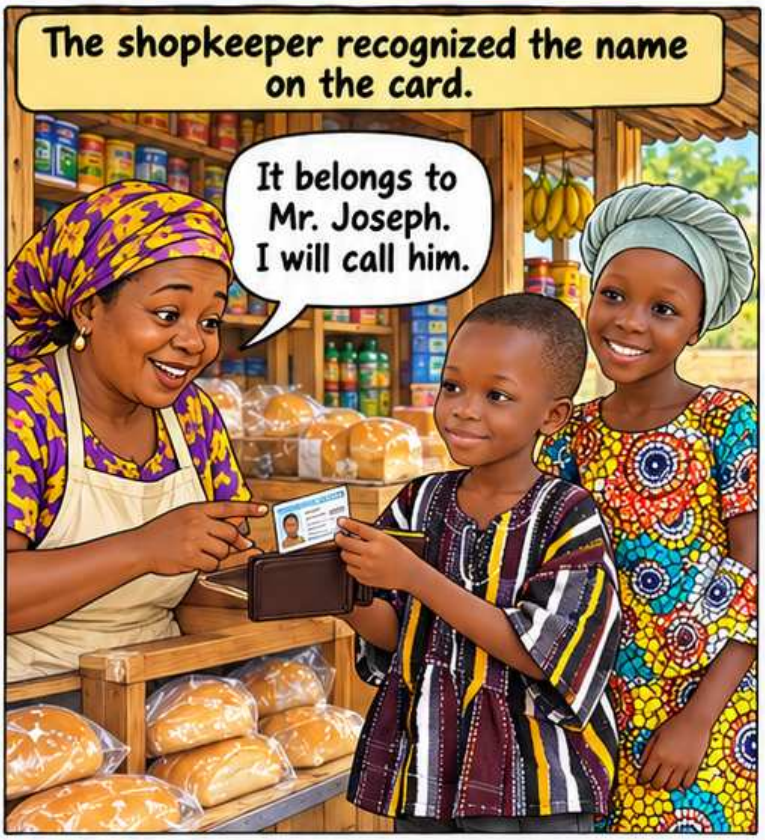
Mackafui remembered that the money belonged to someone else.

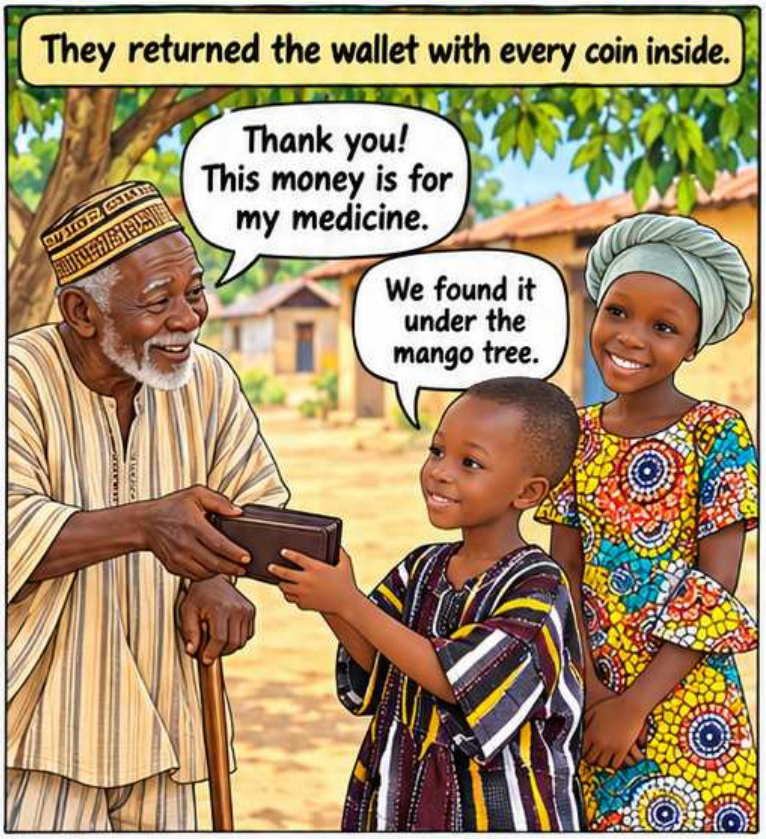


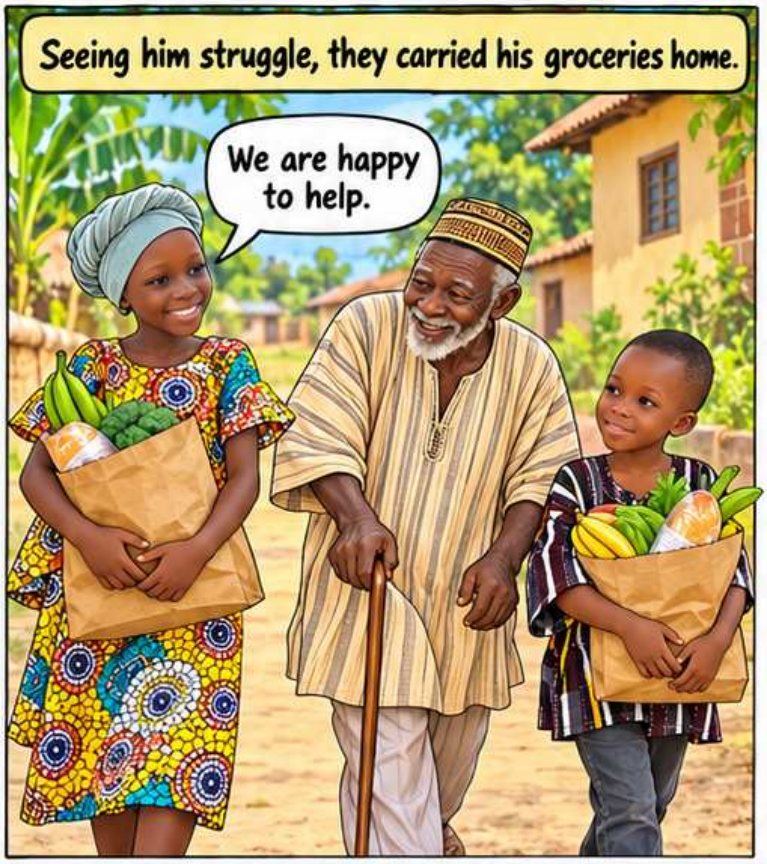
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MACKAFUI AND DECO

THE WALLET AND THE PROMISE – CONTINUED.









MORAL: Let faith guide your choices. Tell the truth, care for others, and keep your promises.

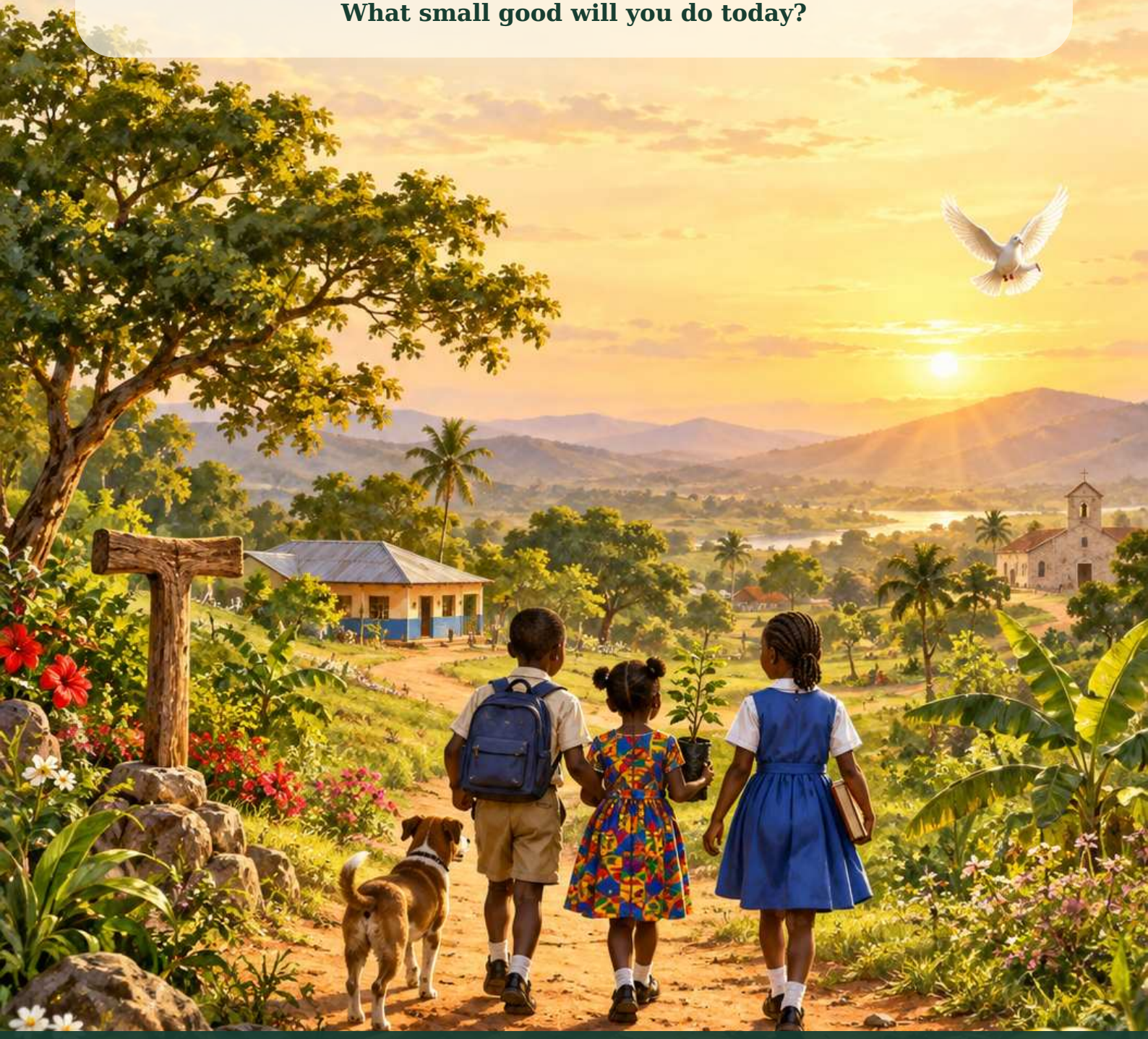
Small acts of goodness make a big difference.

PIONEER KIDS

The story continues with you.

Be truthful. Be kind. Care for creation.
Listen for God’s call in the people you meet.

What small good will you do today?



A NEW ISSUE EVERY MONTH

Share a short inspiring story:

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